

PROSPER AWUNI

Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | SIEM/XDR | Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Security Engineer with over five years of experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and detection engineering within large enterprise environments. I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL)-based threat detection, Microsoft Defender (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, and detection-as-code practices that improve detection fidelity and reduce analyst workload. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I build and maintain detection logic across multiple platforms, develop automated response workflows, and drive the security engineering capability for an 8,000-user organisation. I am UK-based, comfortable operating fully remotely, and able to travel to client or company sites as required at short notice. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and am passionate about building scalable, high-fidelity detection capabilities that keep pace with evolving adversary techniques.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM / XDR Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Kusto Query Language (KQL), log ingestion, data connector configuration, workspace management
- **Detection Engineering:** Detection rule authoring, detection-as-code, use case development, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection coverage, telemetry analysis, alert fidelity tuning
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Cloud
- **SOAR / Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks (Logic Apps), CrowdStrike Falcon SOAR, PowerShell scripting, automated response workflows, API-based integrations
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Microsoft Defender for Cloud, cloud telemetry and log management
- **Endpoint Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, digital forensics triage, investigation and containment
- **Scripting:** PowerShell (advanced), Python (working knowledge), API integrations, automation pipeline development
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2025 to Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Engineer and maintain Microsoft Sentinel as the primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, including data connector onboarding, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rule development, and scheduled analytics rule tuning to reduce false-positive rates
- Lead detection engineering activities, authoring MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM to identify adversary behaviours from initial access through to exfiltration
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and CrowdStrike Falcon SOAR, automating incident response workflows and integrating with external APIs to accelerate containment actions
- Manage the full Microsoft Defender suite including Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across an 8,000-user estate, configuring policies, alert suppression,

and threat response actions

- Conduct proactive threat hunting using Kusto Query Language (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, analysing telemetry from endpoints, identities, cloud workloads, and email to surface indicators of compromise (IoCs) and techniques, tactics, and procedures (TTPs)
- Maintain cloud security posture within Microsoft Azure, managing Entra ID Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Microsoft Defender for Cloud alerting and recommendations
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) across the endpoint estate, engineering prevention policies, custom Indicator of Attack (IoA) rules, and response workflows
- Manage vulnerability management lifecycle using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), combining automated scanning with continuous attack simulation to prioritise remediation by exploitability and business impact
- Develop PowerShell scripts to automate repetitive security operational tasks, including log collection, alert enrichment, and reporting pipelines
- Lead incident response activities following NIST 800-61 methodology, conducting post-incident reviews and translating findings into new detection logic and playbook improvements

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2022 to March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Operated Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, writing Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries to develop detection content, investigate security events, and conduct threat hunting across endpoint, identity, and network telemetry sources
- Deployed and maintained CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the endpoint estate, creating prevention policies, custom detection rules, and response playbooks aligned to MITRE ATT&CK techniques
- Performed alert triage and incident response using SIEM data, escalating and managing incidents in accordance with the NIST 800-61 incident response framework
- Built and tuned SOAR automation workflows to reduce analyst workload and accelerate mean time to respond to common alert types
- Maintained Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft 365 Defender policies, investigating alerts and conducting live response sessions on compromised endpoints
- Managed Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and privileged identity governance, ensuring access control standards were maintained across cloud and hybrid environments
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-rated remediation reports and tracking vulnerability closure against defined service level agreements (SLAs)
- Used PowerShell scripting to automate security operational tasks including configuration audits, log parsing, and automated reporting
- Supported threat intelligence analysis using the MITRE ATT&CK framework, mapping current threat actor techniques to existing detection coverage and identifying gaps

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 to March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed endpoint security tooling and security policy enforcement across the SaaS platform infrastructure, maintaining platform hardening and patch compliance
- Supported security monitoring activities, access control configuration, and network security rule management
- Contributed to Quality Management System (QMS) documentation and security framework alignment activities
- Assisted with IT infrastructure build, operating system patching, and vulnerability assessment to support a secure software delivery environment
- Used PowerShell scripting to automate routine infrastructure and security configuration tasks

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a comprehensive detection-as-code library in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), covering MITRE ATT&CK techniques across credential access, lateral movement, and exfiltration,

improving detection coverage from reactive to proactive at UAL

- Engineered SOAR playbooks that automated the full investigation and containment lifecycle for high-volume alert types including phishing, endpoint compromise, and identity anomalies, reducing mean time to respond by automating triage steps
- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft 365 Defender across an 8,000-user estate, delivering unified XDR visibility and significantly reducing endpoint blind spots
- Designed and implemented CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM integration with Microsoft Sentinel, creating cross-platform detection correlation across endpoint and cloud telemetry sources
- Established vulnerability management as a continuous operational programme using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), enabling risk-based remediation prioritisation and consistent reduction in open critical findings
- Developed PowerShell-based automation scripts that reduced manual operational security tasks, including automated alert enrichment, log collection, and compliance reporting pipelines

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Remote (UK)